one of his anthologies as well. Then F 6* SF rejected "It's Such a Beautiful Day."

Even my appearances in the magazines at this time were minor. The December 1953 Astounding contained "The Micropsychiatric Applications of Thiotimoline," 7 which I thought better than the original thiotimoline article, but which, of course, didn't have the impact of the first.

The December 1953 Universe had "Everest." 8 The editors had tried to patch it up very slightly to take into account Hillary's successful conquest of Mount Everest but didn't succeed, so there I was—I had published a story that depended on Mount Everest's not having been climbed half a year after it was climbed. 9

24 The year 1953 ended with my having published two more books:

9. Second Foundation (Gnome) 10. Lucky Starr and the Pirates of the Asteroids (Doubleday)

This was a comedown from the four of the year before. I was not, however, complaining, for the figures on my writing income showed clearly that the whopping earnings of the year before were no accident. In 1953, in fact, my writing income was $9,660, a little over $1,000 more.

7 See Only a Trillion (Abelard-Schuman, 1957).

8 See Buy Jupiter and Other Stories.

9 This was no tragedy. I frequently tell the story of the "Everest" fiasco in my after-dinner talks and do so with great success. The story about the story has earned me far more money than ever the story itself did.

than the year before and very close to the $10,000 I had long ago estimated to be the absolute most it was possible to earn as a science-fiction writer.

My school income in 1953 was $5,750, slightly above the figure for 1952, but only three fifths of my writing income. The total was over $15,000, a dizzying sum.

2 5

Though writing was making me wealthy beyond the dreams of Croesus (well, that's how it seemed to me at the time), there was unpleasantness at school.